The population of a town was monitored.

Exactly 5 years after monitoring began, the population was 58 000

Exactly 10 years after monitoring began, the population was 65 000

Given that the population of the town, P thousand, t years after monitoring began can be modelled by the equation

$$P^2 = a + bt^3$$

where a and b are constants,

(a) find the value of a and the value of b.

(3)

According to the model, exactly T years after monitoring began, the population was 85 000

Making your method clear,

(b) find the value of T, giving your answer to one decimal place.

(*Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.*)

(2)